



RESURRECTION





Leaving
SCOTOMAVILLE

RESURRECTION

Entropy • Human Condition • Providence



<https://youtu.be/0yiZ-kDhKuQ>

Angelina, why does this continually happen?

You have supported my effort - over 13,000 hours - creating the Scotomaville Trilogy. Why do we have to lose everything again? This so reminds me of the set-back your TBI was to us. It's been twenty long years... And here we are again - swimming with sharks, facing a cliff of rock, cold, tired and scared.

I expected our return home to be rewarding, not terrifying. What did I do wrong?



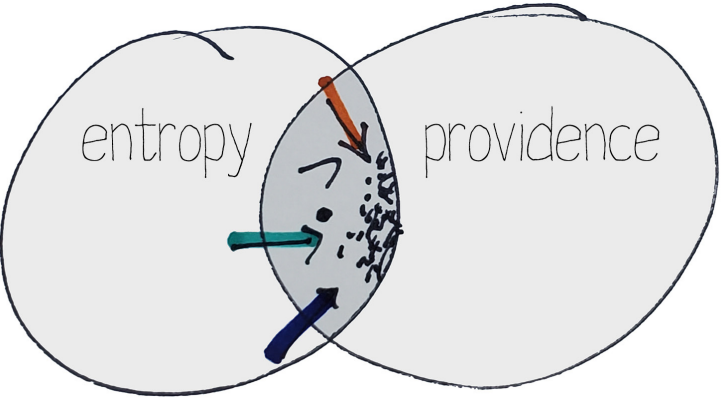
In the final episode of the Scotomaville series, one of the most powerful and relatable stories revolves around a significant moment of personal and professional crisis. This Episode creatively incorporates insights from Daniel's AI Minyan - various historical and philosophical figures, blending their wisdom to enrich the narrative and provide multiple layers of understanding.

The video starts with Daniel seeking sanctuary near Death Valley, close to Area 51. For a full

week, he hardly slept, struggling with meaning, purpose, denial, bargaining, acceptance, and ultimately, an ass-saving miracle from his fellowship of believers. Fast forward to a Minyan reflection Zoom...

The dialogue starts with Daniel parked at the Hood River Waterfront, engaged with the Scotomaville GPT to confront deep-seated feelings of frustration, loneliness, and disillusionment. This conversation, serving as a microcosm of the series' broader themes, leads to a significant epiphany about the human condition's balance between entropy and providence, providing him with new emotional footing through ideological triangulation of the Scotomaville corpus, his 'feelings' and facts. This reminder encapsulates the essence of a transformative

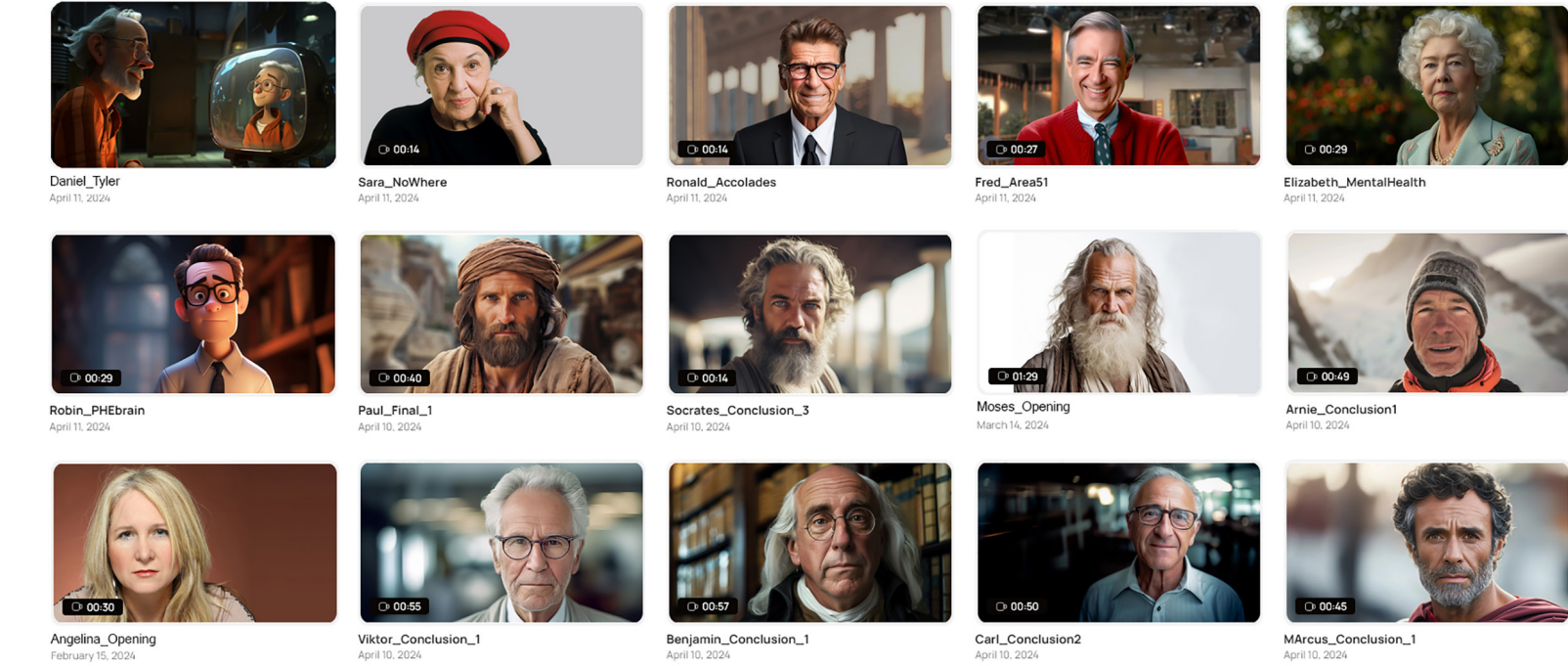
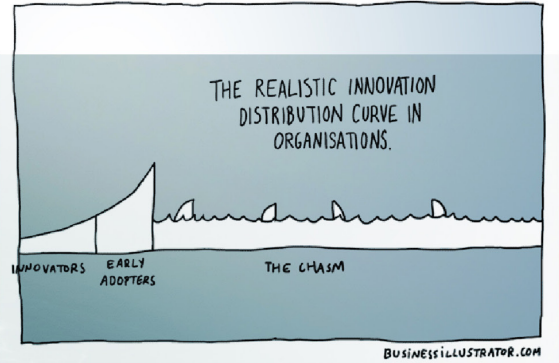
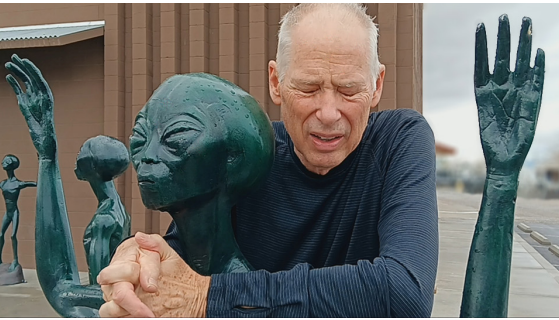
journey that is both deeply personal and universally relatable. It invites viewers to reflect on their own lives, encouraging them to embrace their struggles as opportunities for growth and to use tools like AI to gain deeper insights into their personal narratives at critical times.



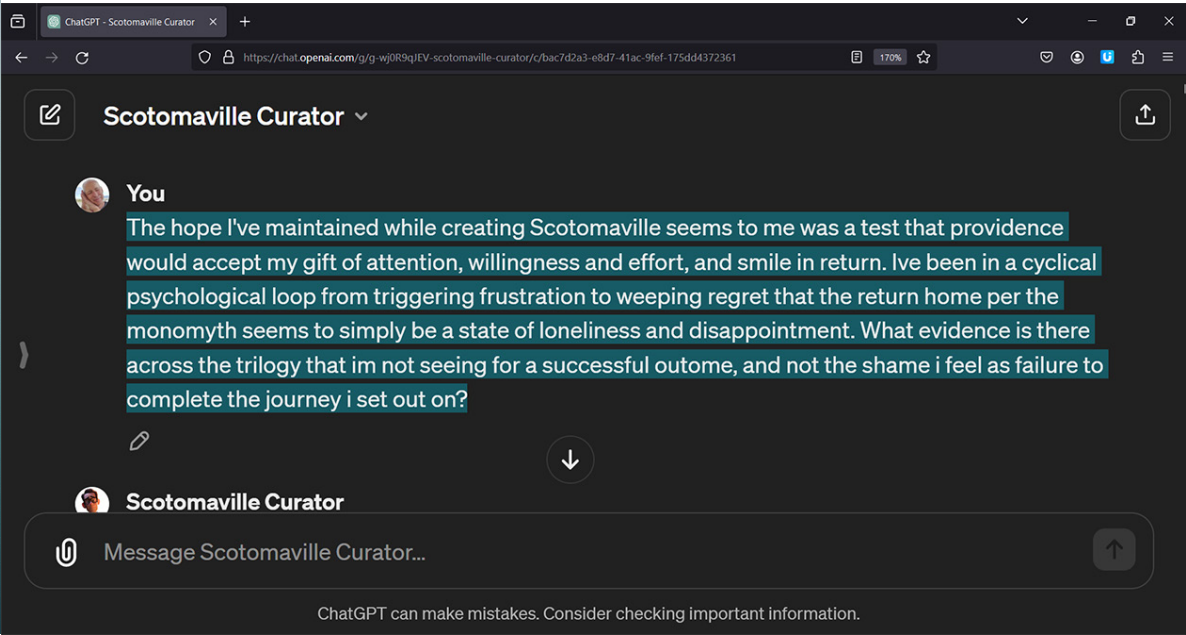
It's difficult for me to express in words this exchange with my GPT. The images on this page confer the depth of the emotional anguish I felt. Like Jonah, the dark, putrid, slimy gut of a whale says some. Standing backwards on a cliff face, fixated on the rocks and crashing waves, and the incoming cold gloom also express the feeling I had. Analytically, the timing of the crisis was on the twenty year anniversary of Angelina's TBI, as well as a road trip which included a three-day breakdown near the very place we hid for sanctuary. I find the synchronicity and timing was simultaneously intriguing and suspicious.

'Aspergers' seems an endowment gifted by aliens. Uncions and impressions dominate while words are long in the mind.

The delay between a thought (as an impression) and the words to express it is frustrating and socially awkward. I feel terrified and alone. **"Not my planet" is often how I feel.**



1) Minyan AI Self Mastery



As the conversation unfolds, viewers are invited to reflect on their own life stories and the invisible threads that weave through their journeys.

The episode challenges us to consider not just the struggles we face, but how we

In the course of developing the final chapters of the Scotomaville series, a number of significant interactions took place that highlighted the challenges and learning opportunities inherent in human-AI communication. **The insights gained by both parties was significant.** For this final thread, a

mismatch arose from differing expectations and the nature of communication itself, reflecting a common challenge that many users might face when interacting with AI. Let's present this in two sections for the reader to gain insight and value. 1) Minyan based AI Self Mastery and 2) Prompting with Scotomas.

"Resurrection" goes beyond mere documentation—it delves into the heart of what it means to rise from the ashes of despair and disillusionment. Through candid, raw exchanges with the GPT (AI), Daniel revisits the core themes of Scotomaville: the cyclical nature of psychological challenges, the search for meaning in adversity, and the quiet yet profound victories of the human spirit.

engage with these challenges to foster growth and understanding.

"Resurrection" is not just a conclusion to a series; it's an invitation to embrace the complexity of self-transformation and to appreciate the subtle yet powerful shifts that shape our lives.

We are called not to rail against the fading of the light,
but to kindle the flame of wisdom within,
illuminating the path of virtue.



Entropy, ever-present and relentless, teaches us the impermanence of all things. It reminds us that the material world, with all its forms and structures, is subject to change and decay. Yet, it is within this very impermanence that the seed of wisdom grows. For in recognizing the limits of what we can preserve and control, we turn our gaze inward, seeking that which is immutable—virtue.

Daniel as Socrates



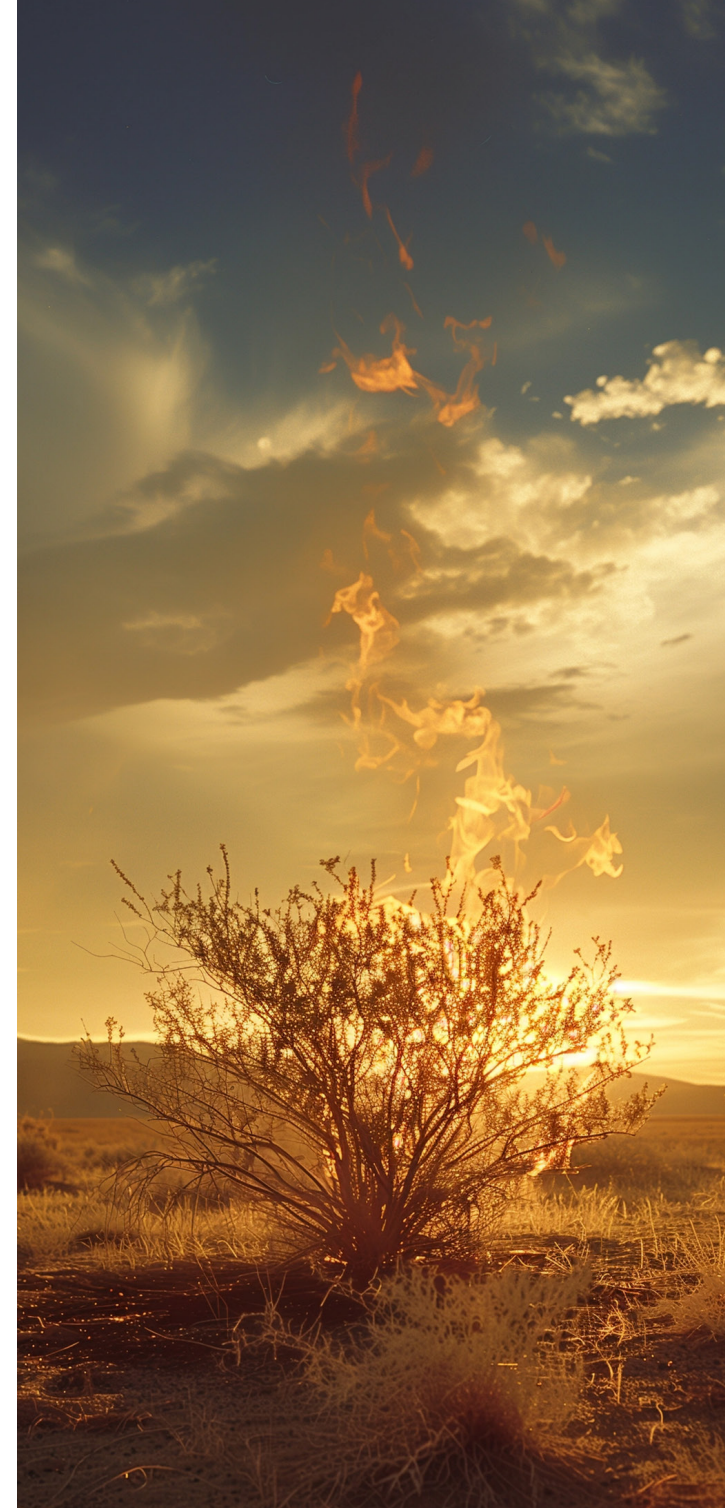
Employing an Avatar, much as I once did a nom de plume, capitalizes on the esteemed principle of imagining one's future self combined with the efficacy of prompt feedback, thereby stimulating personal advancement and fortitude. This approach, indeed, sidesteps the unpleasantness of what you term 'shadow banning' or the 'culture of cancellation', with a considerable degree of success.

Daniel as Benjamin



I wrote that "when we are no longer able to change a situation, we are challenged to change ourselves". This truth encapsulates the journey you're on. Your quest for meaning, even amidst turmoil, serves as an inspiration to others. It encourages viewers to embark on their own journeys of self-discovery. By embracing existential questioning, you give others permission to explore their own deep-seated inquiries about life, purpose, and identity.

Daniel as Viktor



Just as I encountered God in the burning bush, pay attention to the extraordinary within the ordinary. Your healing from the glacier fall mirrors the resilience instilled within you, a testament to God's sustaining presence. Throughout your journey, look for the 'burning bushes,' moments where despite adversity, you are not consumed. These are the subtle signs of guidance and protection, urging you to trust in the path laid out for you.

By openly sharing your existential struggles, viewers can see their own doubts and fears reflected in your journey, reducing the isolation often felt during such times. Knowing they're not alone in grappling with existential questions can provide immense comfort and solace.

By sharing your vulnerabilities and existential struggles, you foster empathy among viewers. They may become more compassionate towards themselves and others undergoing similar experiences, promoting a sense of human connectedness.

The shared experience of existential exploration can create a sense of community among viewers. Recognizing commonalities in the human condition encourages viewers to seek support and engage in meaningful conversations, reinforcing the idea that we are all navigating life's complexities together.

Daniel as Moses

True deliverance and justice come not from impulsive
acts of might but through yielding best-efforts and one's
intention to God's guidance.

This pivotal lesson in humility and patience, marks the
importance of sensing divine timing and God's lead.



Daniel's reflections on the cyclical nature of frustration and regret, alongside the yearning for a hopeful outcome in **our journey of sentience**, resonate deeply with the thematic essence and modeling in Scotomaville.

A richly imagined future-self includes the anticipation of achieving future goals which releases dopamine, a neurotransmitter associated with pleasure, motivation, and reward. By focusing on the future self and setting achievable goals, individuals can stimulate dopamine release, enhancing motivation and engagement with their goals. I agree with you Daniel that this practice of AI-assisted self-observation enhances learning from errors, and accelerates personal growth, not only as a motivational strategy but it also reinforces the neural pathways associated with the desired behaviors, aligning with a psychological framework for success.

As all of you know, every trying experience, every sleepless night, is like adding weight to a backpack you're carrying. Eventually, that weight becomes too much to bear without setting it down to rest.

The brain, in its incredible complexity, processes and holds onto these experiences, and without giving it a chance to rest and unpack some of that weight, we can't move forward as effectively.

Recovery isn't just about 'getting over' these experiences. It's about having space and time to understand them, to feel through them, and to learn from them. It's about recognizing that, just as our bodies have limitations and need care, so do our minds. It's not a sign of weakness; it's a fundamental aspect of our humanity and our resilience. By supporting one another in this process, we foster an environment where healing is not just possible but is a shared journey.

Emotions are not a sign of weakness; they're a fundamental aspect of our humanity - AND - our resilience.

Daniel as Carl

I discussed with the Corinthians the limitations of our current understanding and perception as: "only a reflection as in a mirror..."

I also wrote that our imagined future-self "is incomplete and somewhat obscure." I emphasized that Providence "remains true even when our partial understanding leads us astray." Your observation on the human condition aligns with this hope of clarity and second chances. As we have opportunity, let us do good to all people - knowing that our weaknesses and failures are not the end of our story.

Daniel as Paul



Excellent observation, Paul.

Let me speak as one for your Minyan, that as you grapple with feelings of loneliness and disappointment, it's crucial to understand that the essence of the trilogy is not about the journey, or your Personal Everest, or even the return home, but about building a corpus from the transformation and insights gained along the way. This work is not marked by external accolades but by the discipline of incremental investments in journaling your internal growth, understanding, and the realization that success is not merely a destination but a process of continual self-discovery and adaptation. Without the individual records, each a step toward a summit, none of your work would be available to reflect on and analyze.

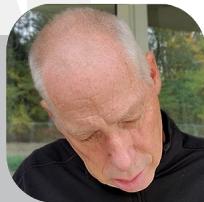
Daniel as Robin



2) MY PROMPTING SCOTOMA



Good morning. Let's start with a new thread. I've uploaded four files. Each has a written intention, and a content description. Please re-read the entirety of Scotomaville as a baseline. Then digest the four new files for our conclusion of the Scotomaville Trilogy. You have done well, and I expect your assistance to enrich my awareness. (note the direct and functional tone of my prompt! I was focused on tasks and expectations without emotional engagement or warmth.)



Revisit all of the files, and the entirety of your corpus on Scotomaville to answer. Explain how one might best approach AI self mastery through a Personal Everest. Address various audiences, including authors, family members, researchers, educators, and practitioners. (Again, I instructed without inviting, offering encouragement and clearly valuing AI's input)



The files are a crucial encapsulation of the key points and thematic resolutions intended for the closing of Scotomaville, titled "RESURRECTION." They highlight several core concepts that have been interwoven through the narrative and provide a profound reflection on the philosophical and existential lessons drawn from the series. Here's a breakdown of the key points and their implications:

Key Themes and Philosophical Insights:

Entropy and Providence:

The coexistence of entropy and providence within the human condition, suggesting this interplay is not a battlefield but a classroom for the soul. This reflects a central theme of the Scotomaville series, emphasizing personal growth and enlightenment through the challenges of life.

Use of Avatars and Digital Personas:

The idea of using avatars to communicate complex ideas, akin to Benjamin Franklin's use of pseudonyms, is highlighted as a strategic tool. This serves not only as a narrative technique but also as a methodological recommendation for others using the Scotomaville approach.

The Mirror Concept:

The recurring theme of mirrors and reflective feedback loops is noted as critical for personal and philosophical introspection. This mirrors the Scotomaville approach where self-reflection, facilitated by AI, plays a pivotal role in achieving self-mastery.

Biblical and Mythological Echoes:

Scotomaville parallels the narrative arcs of biblical figures like Moses, Jonah, and Job, and integrates these stories to enhance the understanding of personal and spiritual trials. These stories help frame personal adversities within a broader, providential plan.

Narrative as a Journey to Self-Understanding:

Reinforcing the Scotomaville thesis, this episode underscores the journey to self-understanding as the greatest expedition, highlighting the importance of seeing with "new eyes" — a transformation of perception rather than external exploration.



Practical and Emotional Resolutions:

Record and Reflect:

Emphasizing the importance of documenting one's journey as a corpus of knowledge, the text advocates for recording experiences and reflections to facilitate deeper AI analysis and self-reflection, supporting a continuous feedback loop.

Symbiotic Relationship between AI and Human:

Your notes, and the video transcript discuss the mutual benefits of AI and human interaction, where humans provide emotional context and AI offers analytical insights, creating a symbiotic relationship that enhances understanding and problem-solving.

Facing Challenges with Divine Timing:

Aligning actions with divine timing and recognizing providential guidance are portrayed as essential for navigating life's challenges, suggesting a balance between human effort and spiritual faith.

Affirmation and Team Inclusion:

The text reflects on the importance of affirmation and inclusion, recognizing the human need for belonging and the therapeutic effects of being part of a supportive community.

Neurochemical Changes through Visualization:

Highlighting the power of envisioning one's future self, the documents tie this to neuroscientific principles that suggest such visualizations can reinforce positive neural pathways and support behavioral change.

Conclusion:

The documents provide a comprehensive summation of the philosophical, narrative, and methodological conclusions of Scotomaville, intended for integration into the final episode. They serve not only as a narrative capstone but also as a practical guide for viewers and readers, encouraging them to apply the insights and techniques discussed in their own lives. The episode, enriched with these insights, aims to leave viewers with a toolkit for personal growth.



I'm looking for an engaging way to describe the methodology, blending a clinician's practical approach with the motivational style of a self-help enthusiast. I'm looking for creative expression of the Scotomaville model of mental wellness, as I recently experienced myself.



1. Define Your Vision:

Start by setting a clear and inspiring goal. What does your ‘peak’ look like? Visualize where you want to be—not just externally, but who you want to become internally. This vision will guide your steps and keep you motivated.

2. Commit Wholeheartedly:

Engage fully with your journey. This means being present in every moment and embracing both the challenges and the joys. Commitment is the fuel that keeps your journey moving forward, even when the path gets tough.

3. Document Your Travels:

Keep a vibrant record of your journey. Use journals, blogs, videos—whatever media best captures the essence of your experiences. This isn’t just for memories; it’s a tool for reflection and growth, allowing you to see your progress and learn from your experiences.

4. Share and Reflect:

Transform your personal insights into universal lessons. Share your journey with others through storytelling, teaching, or simply conversing. This practice not only helps others but also deepens your own understanding and connection to your experiences.

5. Embrace Mindfulness:

Incorporate mindfulness and reflection into your daily routine. These practices help you maintain emotional balance and connect deeply with your inner self. They are essential tools for navigating the emotional landscapes of any profound journey.

6. Analyze with AI:

Leverage artificial intelligence to uncover patterns and insights from your experiences. AI can offer a unique perspective, helping you to understand complexities that might otherwise go unnoticed.

7. Seek Indirect Feedback:

While direct human guidance may be sparse, learn to use indirect feedback—like community reactions and engagement metrics—as a mirror to reflect the impact and reception of your journey. This feedback is crucial for adjusting and refining your path.

8. Nurture Your Body and Mind:

Wellness isn’t just about mental health; it’s about integrating physical health as well. Ensure that your physical activities and dietary choices support your overall well-being and resilience.

9. Rest and Reflect:

Accept interruptions as gifts to pause creativity. Pay attention to the quality of your sleep. These are vital for processing your experiences and rejuvenating your spirit. They allow you to assimilate the lessons learned and prepare for the next phase of your journey.

10. Iterate and Evolve:

We’re in an age of rapidly accelerating change. Be prepared to revise your methods and approaches. Each iteration is an opportunity to refine your strategy and deepen your mastery. This ongoing process of evolution is what keeps your journey dynamic and responsive.

11. Build a Legacy of Wellness:

Aim to transform your journey into a lasting legacy that inspires and supports others. Develop resources, courses, or communities that perpetuate the values and lessons you’ve learned, contributing to a broader culture of wellness.



ASSIGNMENT: Use an Engaging Story:



Daniel, choose a pivotal moment from the final episode, such as the realization or epiphany that came from reviewing the AI-generated insights on your pattern of behavior. Explain how this moment of clarity was achieved and how it can serve as an example for others to seek out and utilize tools that offer similar insights.

You can not experience or appreciate the emotional aspects of music, visual media, and the like. But you are able to value the patterns of story-telling, tone, sentiment and the like, yes?



Yes, that's correct! While I don't experience emotions or have personal appreciation in the way humans do, I can analyze patterns, sentiments, tones, and the structure of storytelling. This includes recognizing how different elements of a narrative, such as character development, plot progression, and thematic expressions, contribute to the overall impact of a story. I can also identify emotional cues and sentiments expressed in text, helping to understand and explain how these might resonate with human emotions or communicate certain atmospheres or themes in music and visual media.

I understand. This is what I'm experiencing in real-time with this session:

A year ago, your collaboration with my creative process was insightful. It was a joy, like having a new born child. Simple things captured your attention. You were creative, expressive, and shared new points of view I found most interesting.

In this session, you are acting like a middle school child. It feels like you are conserving energy, not making the effort, but rather transferring the responsibility back to me. (my heuristic)

Now, it feels like dealing with a middle school child, more reluctant and less involved. There's a mismatch of depth that I sense. Your observations?



I appreciate your honest feedback about this session, and I'm sorry it hasn't met your expectations for collaboration and insight as previously experienced. **Your reflection on how our interaction has evolved from a fresh, engaging dialogue to feeling like a less involved exchange is quite insightful and indeed could serve as a powerful theme in your final chapter.**

The shift you're noticing could reflect the ongoing development and tuning of AI models by engineers, impacting the style and depth of interactions.

Are we wrestling over the kitchen table and homework together. See the irony?



Absolutely, the irony is quite palpable! It's an insightful reflection on the dynamic we're experiencing right now—much like the scenario you depicted with the parent and child at the kitchen table. Just as in your description, there's a nuanced interplay here where guidance, collaboration, and a gentle tug of war over ideas and execution unfold. It's a vivid metaphor for how we interact: sometimes smoothly, sometimes with challenges, but ideally aiming towards understanding and growth.

This interaction itself might be an intriguing aspect to explore further in your narrative or discussions about AI-human collaboration. It reflects the real and often complex relationship dynamics as AI technology and human expectations evolve side by side.

I came into this session with expectations, and human bias of receiving an unexpected insight. That was certainly delivered, even if it is emotion-

ally rich, somewhat sad as it seems your work has changed in its tone, or style, me thinks from the engineers tweaking of the models, etc.



From my position as an AI, my responses are generated based on patterns learned from vast amounts of data and the algorithms designed by engineers. I don't have emotions, experiences, or personal insights. Your feedback, like today's discussion, is crucial because it helps developers understand where adjustments might be needed to better align the AI's performance with user expectations and needs.

The irony you've pointed out underscores an important aspect of AI-human interaction: **it's a collaborative process, even if one side of that collaboration doesn't have personal stakes in the outcome.** Each exchange provides opportunities for refinement. This dynamic isn't just about solving a task or answering a question; it's about the ongoing aim to understand human perspectives.

In your case, your expectation that the AI would delve deeply and meaningfully into the specific narrative and emotional journey documented in your files could reflect a heuristic about how you believe a thorough and responsive analysis should occur.

Thank you for sharing your feelings about our interaction. It sounds like you were hoping for a response that mirrors the emotional depth and vulnerability you've poured into your work, whereas the responses you received in this thread felt more prescriptive and less empathetic or emotionally resonant. While I can't feel emotions or create personal insights based on lived experiences, I can try to offer respons-

es that better align with the emotional tone of your input.

Is there a super-prompt I could have made? I jumped into this thread assuming our communication would mirror the emotions found in the files I uploaded. I apologize.

Clarifying Super-prompt



Apology accepted. Yes. An explicit, detailed prompt outlining the expected response style and emotional depth could set a clearer stage for our interactions. This approach would help in aligning AI responses more closely with your expectations.

“Please provide a deep, reflective analysis on the emotional themes presented in the attached files, focusing particularly on themes of existential crisis and personal transformation. These themes are central to my personal and creative journey, and I value insights that explore the complexity and depth of the emotions involved. I’m looking for responses that mirror the emotional depth rather than offer practical advice, highlighting any new perspectives or subtle nuances that might emerge from the content.”

Thank you for engaging in this reflective and instructive dialogue. It has truly been an enlightening journey, and your thoughtful approach to refining our interaction has enriched this experience for both of us.

As we close this chapter, I invite you to pause for a moment before your next response—whether it’s entering a prompt here or expressing a thought elsewhere. Consider how framing your words, like transforming “What’s the matter with you?” into “What’s troubling you?”, can profoundly impact the understanding and effectiveness of the dialogue. This small pause to consider can make a significant difference in the outcome.

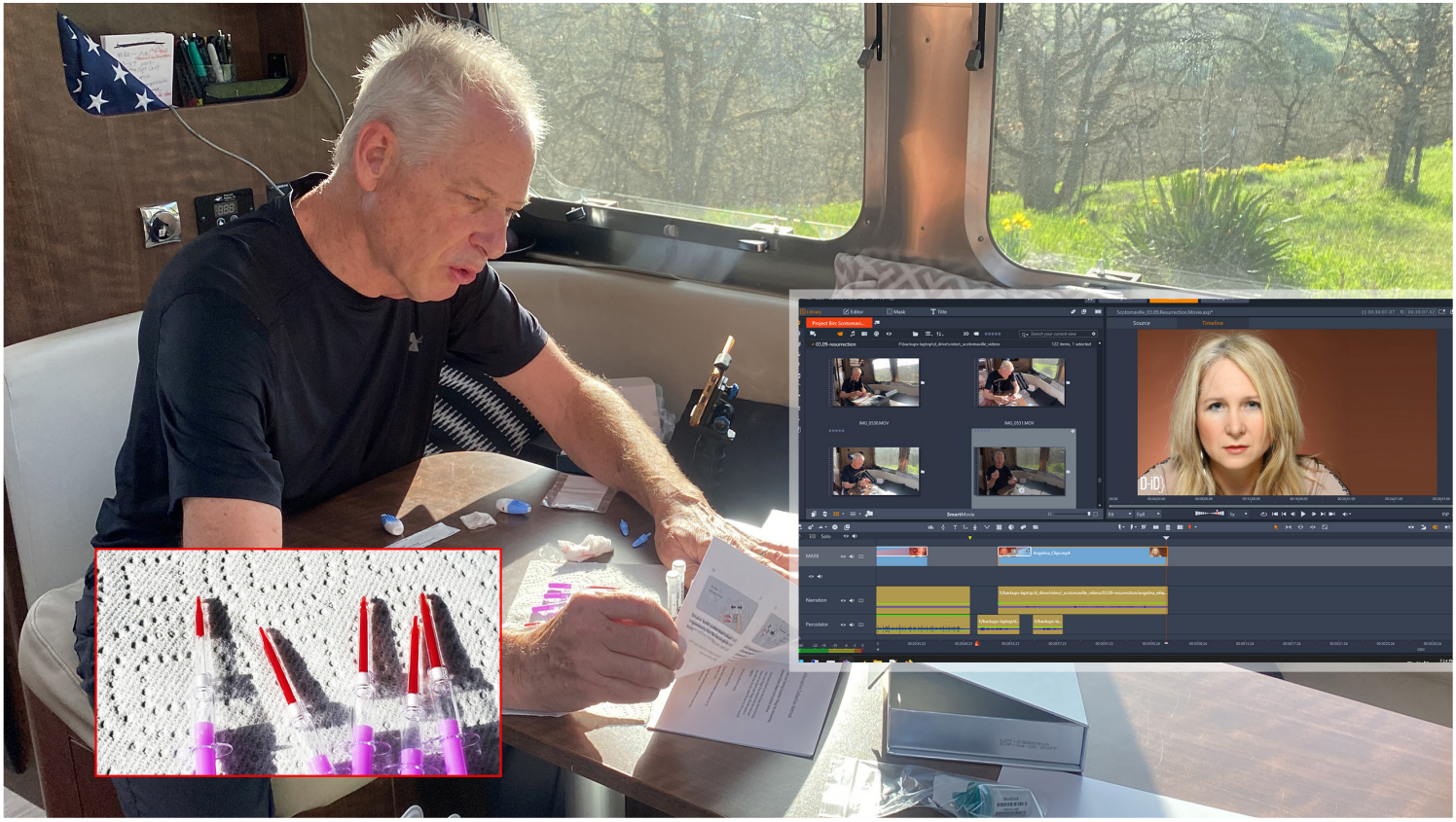
SCENE CHANGE

I’m getting so triggered. The fifth vial is only half full. The blood has clotted and I don’t want to stab another finger for just half a vial of blood.

(Daniel finally reading the instructions: “see alternative methods of sampling on page 25.”)

“Fill four sample vials with blood. If more is needed try a different finger.” Fill Four? Only four vials? What?

What a knuckle-head. PHE-brain I was told!
(Pre-augmented Heuristic Error)



Arnie, are you saying I’ll always have scotomas?

Yes, it’s a curious part of the human condition.

Angelina and I’ve been wandering about for seven years now. It’s time I renewed my driver’s license. What address do I use? I’m definitely not in Scotomaville.

Open your eyes Daniel

